

December

10

1911

Double winner

Polish physicist Marie Curie received her second Nobel Prize for discovering the elements radium and polonium, following her win for her research on radiation in 1903. This historic double win made her the first person to be awarded Nobel Prizes in different categories.



Also on this day

1823 British palaeontologist **Mary Anning** discovered the first complete skeleton of a *Plesiosaurus*, a prehistoric marine reptile, in the cliffs of Lyme Regis in Dorset, England.

1996 South African president **Nelson Mandela** signed the country's new constitution into effect, confirming that South Africa was now a democracy.

1901

Nobel Prize

To recognize outstanding achievements in chemistry, literature, medicine, peace, and physics, the first set of Nobel Prizes was given out. This fulfilled the last wishes of celebrated chemist Alfred Nobel and took place on the fifth anniversary of his death.



Traffic lights

1868

The world's first traffic lights were introduced outside the Palace of Westminster in London, UK. They made use of an adapted railway signal system, with semaphore arms and red and green gas lamps to indicate "stop" and "move with caution" for horse carriages and pedestrians.



Born this day

1815 **Ada Lovelace**, British mathematician. She worked on algorithms for an early computing machine, and is considered the world's first computer programmer.